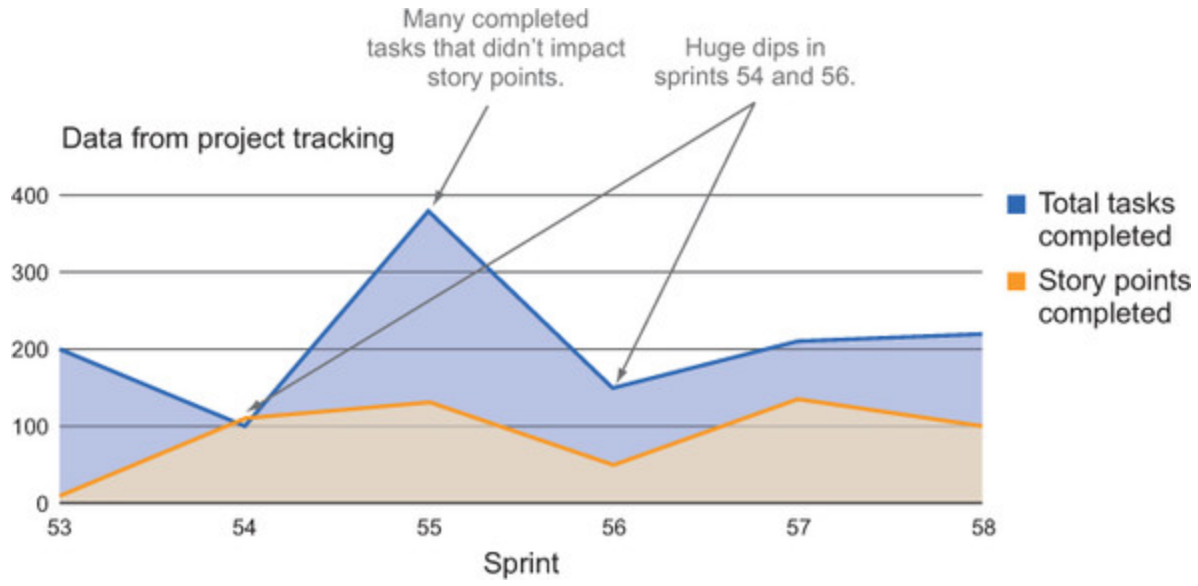
Having data from all over the place in a single database that you're applying formulas to is great. Asking everyone in your company to query that data from a command line probably isn't the best approach to communicate effectively. Data is such a part of the fabric of how business is done today that there is a plethora of frameworks for visualizing it. Ideally you should use a distributed system that allows everyone access to the charts, graphs, radiators, dashboards, and whatever else you want to show.

Keep in mind that data can be interpreted numerous ways, and statistics can be construed to prove different points of view. It's important to display the data you want to show in such a way that it, as clearly as possible, answers the questions you're asking. Let's look at one example.

If you want to see how productive your team is, you can start by finding out how many tasks are being completed. The problem with measuring the number of tasks is that a handful of very difficult tasks could be much more work than many menial ones. To balance that possibility you can add the amount of effort that went into completing those tasks, measured in figure 1.12 with story points.

Figure 1.12. Project tracking data for a team for a few sprints



Whoa! Look at those dips around sprints 54 and 56! This obviously points to a problem, but what is the problem? You know that the development